The Chill Concept: the museum evolution

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Abstract: A pop-up museum with a collection of curated projects and creative spaces designing a community. How, exactly, can a museum appear and then disappear That's a question we asked ourselves many times when The Chill Concept was just an idea. In thinking about the pop-up phenomenon in the retail world, we saw the subtle brilliance of the movement. In creating 'The Chill Concept' (TCC), based on this model, we have not run, but sprinted to conceptualize, construct and open the world's first pop-up museum. The notion of a space existing for just a brief period of time seemed antithetical to any good business practice, where brand loyalty and repeat customers are at the root of success. How could you have either if your business intentionally disappeared a short time after opening? However, pop-uppers are not seeking loyalty. They seek clients who want to experience something now because it won't be there tomorrow. This model embodies innovation and rethinking in uncertain economic times. We didn't doubt whether this new business would work – we had seen it succeed in other areas. Pop-up shops? Sure; so, why not pop-up museums? By trying to quantify the shelf life of contemporary art, and wondering if one could play the system, we realized that the answer was not in the theoretical pondering, but in the doing. We had to act. So we jumped at the chance to create a real-life pop-up museum, The Chill Concept, in one of USA's most dynamic art districts - Wynwood, Miami, Florida.

Keywords: pop-up museum, art and communities, museums and active citizenship, art and science laboratories, cultural practices, museum alternative

How do we do it?

The Chill Concept (TCC) is made up of a collective of innovators. They are a select, imaginative group of people already working in challenging fields. They can look at an empty lot on a non-descript block and recast it as a majestic, one-of-a-kind museum. They can take an area without focus and turn it into a neighborhood, a vibrant central gathering place. Then, they can start all over again in another corner of the world, fashioning a new space that becomes part of a broader global community.

We support, promote and celebrate the work of innovative people, freeing up these artists to continue to dream and to create. Few people better exemplify this commitment to inspire creation and community expansion than those at 20St Casita. These are whom we call the "Dreamweavers". A Dreamweaver works to make people's lives easier. A Dreamweaver is extraordinary at working on a micro level within the larger field of life coaching.

The key to the experience

TCC provides a unique ambience and experience to our community. To help potential TCC members navigate through our creative spaces and projects, giving them a look at what they can experience, we have divided The Chill Concept into three categories:

Wellness: unique styles of relaxation and healing
Innovation: expanding the creative imagination to recycle what's at hand
Contemporary Art: nurturing alternative, experimental or simply offbeat practices

Popping up how?

TCC will debut – or pop up – and exhibit for a limited number of months: It could be 12, maybe 24 or more. We don't know. But if you miss it – as with Woodstock or Art Basel – you will be out of luck. It will be over, done, gone.

Our wish is to bring Latin, Asian and European flavor and fun to the creative beauty of Wynwood. We want to create a recycled setting with an urban spirit. To do so requires a team – our "Dreamweavers". Each Dreamweaver brings a unique skill set and a trust that

everything will work wonderfully, joyously and happily.

The bones of the project lie in a 7,500-square-foot space, owned by Andreina (Nina) Fuentes (aka "La Dotti"). She cares deeply about Wynwood, and the name of her space, *20St Casita*, is perfect 'Spanglish'. The appeal of this space lies in the potential to cast everyday moments – sounds, tastes, scents, objects, materials, colors and relationships – in a new light to create unforgettable, boundary-pushing experiences. These may be green, extravagant, classic, luxurious or minimal.

The Dreamweavers are putting the flesh – however transitory – on these bones, operating in pop-up creative spaces, projects, events, exhibitions and "chillax sessions" where members, basically are free to chill and relax.

Nina Fuentes (La Dotti) is the "creative director," the force behind The Chill Concept. At the heart of Nina's success is a fearless ability to take something old and grand and update it, without sacrificing charm or historical importance. The charming 20St Casita in Wynwood, built in 1935, has retained its vintage glamour and incorporates contemporary details and spaces that bear the names of Miami based artists, such as Consuelo Castaneda, Ernesto Oroza, Gean Moreno and Natasha Duwin; and international artists, such as Gaston Ugalde, Chanoir and Start from Zero. In addition, designers and craftsmen from around the world will participate. Whether you name-drop Le Corbusier or Bauhaus; or prefer someone like David Edward, creator of The Art Lab; Michael Berger from Berlin; or The Standard creator Andres Balaz from New York, The Chill Concept really does have it all.

So what happens when all the creative players decamp for home?

TCC in its first formulation – a contemporary arts practice, a cultural playground for food, music, projects and spontaneous action – will be gone. Its special constellation of stars will be just a happy moment for the few who enjoyed it. We are creating our own agenda and are not letting the conventions of business set them for us. We are celebrating the pursuit of happiness, based in contemporary art practices, where nothing is permanent. We are embracing the present, living to the fullest; that is the mantra of this pop-up museum.

So the question of temporary-contemporary versus permanent may not be an either/or dichotomy, after all. Ending something in a timely way makes it a timeless memory. That is the subtle brilliance of The Chill Concept.

As The Chill Concept evolves, we look beyond our creative spaces and inspiration to the actual experience. Our focus continues to be cultivating a community of individuals that creates contemporary art projects and spaces around the globe.

We have included snapshots of our members to better convey what the real experience offers.On the following pages we invite you to step into TCC's community of creative spaces and projects. We hope you will be inspired to discover new ways to participate in this museum evolution. We want to bring happiness and wellbeing to our members.

Thirteen values: because happiness is an attitude

Value for Money: any new product or service must be good value for money.

Quality: only the best of the best.

Fun and Cheek: anything that happens at The Chill Concept must add a sense of fun or cheekiness to your life.

Innovation: creative ideas are happening all the time. However, innovation is what allows us to take our ideas, show them, transform them into trendy hipness, and turn them into profits.

Challenge: we are challenging to existing alternatives.

Green Conscience: open to change and embracing it. Open to being aware of our actions and our environment. We just try to do it and use water, tea, coffee, art and spiritual fulfillment as a way to practice being present in our world.

Energy: life is energy, and our job at TCC is to convert our energy and time into a phenomenal experience. We strive to be energetic, efficient, fast, and present.

Enthusiasm: we can do it! Smile, smile, smile! Relax and we bond with you

Faith: have faith (energy, "God", karma, the greater good) that there is something beyond ourselves more permanent and powerful than the individual.

Happiness and wisdom: the ability to take information and knowledge, blend it with life experience, and turn it into wisdom. Intuition is improved by combining wisdom and discipline.

Love: (connection, kindness, warmth, listening ability) love yourself, be kind with others.

Courage: (integrity, confidence, sensitivity) courage is an act of faith to execute your dreams.

Common Touch: mix with people of all walks of life. Listen to people-our customers and employees are our starting point. We treat everyone as an equal.

The Chill Concept: environmental awareness

Renewable, recyclable and sustainable.

Being environmentally conscious is good citizenship. To be environmentally proactive is to be a super citizen. It is not universal behavior, to be sure, but one that we at TCC celebrate and embrace.

We use green building materials when they do not cost more than locally sourced goods. When we buy – or even grow – organic food, we are telling our members that we are supporting the global community.

Environmental awareness is an attitude that can easily become contagious.

Become a member

Enjoy a weekly interactive social experience that supports your personal goals. It's social, supportive and sustaining. We have an innovative model: pay $50 when you start, then attend for free once you have reached your enjoyment goal. If you don't find it to be a fulfilling experience in three months, you can return to a pay-whenever-you-visit membership.

We want members to become active, true participants of the museum community, so we provide a social space for them to get involved as volunteers, as partners and as friends to one another. More importantly, members create youth groups, book circles and activity teams to make even more of a contribution to the creative community.TCC gives members a say in what their membership fee supports, flagging it for a specific creative space, project or chillax session.

TCC offers several sets of membership benefits: a special space for enjoyment, the chance to submit a project for our curated collection, a consulting library of contemporary art books, "book crossings," artifacts to take home for a bit, happy hours, chillax sessions, special foods, yoga, meditation, life-coaching sessions, educational programs and unique events.

The Chill Concept: acontemporary arts practice

TCC is a contemporary arts practice creating positive human connections with art in the moment. We combine contemporary culture and innovation to bring you a sense of wellbeing in an exclusive space in the city of Miami. We believe that if you can take time to connect yourself and recharge, even for just a moment, you will be more productive in work and at home, and you will enjoy happiness as a driver of your success.

As The Chill Concept grows, we want to ensure that every participant has an exceptional experience. We welcome feedback so we can improve your experience and connection with the project. We are inspired, motivated and empowered to change your life and your world. The Chill Concept is your place to just be. Some indulgences are meant to be shared, bring your best friend or significant other. Live! Love! Enjoy! Chill with us.

Integrated wellness

- Tea and coffee bar
- Organic food
- H_2O bar
- The Chill Concept wellness program

Contemporary culture

- Massage lounge
- Chakra lounge
- TCC retreats&workshops
- TCC bookcrossing
- Documentation center
- Artist and curators residences
- Yoga and meditation
- Life coaching through the arts
- ‘Chilax’ Sessions

Innovation

- Kangen water
- New exclusive goods, products and services to improve wellbeing and contemporary culture
- Meeting and event spaces
- Free wifi and charging station
- Chillax stations
- Asocial space

The Chill Concept lessons

- ‘Ars est celare artem’, true art conceals the means by which it is achieved

- Here at The Chill Concept we lead from the ground, but keep it simple
- Making people feel happy and healthy is our bottom line. We expect you to grow your own in this adventure
- We always welcome good ideas
- We don't imitate, we innovate
- No special outfits are required, comfort is our priority
- Our brand travels, and is infinitely elastic
- We love, honor and cherish The Chill Concept
- We believe rules are for breaking
- A pinch of honey and spice adds flavor to do right by our brand
- Challenging as it is, it's equally rewarding and fulfilling to see our guests joyful and expressing their heartfelt gratitude.

What we do is an expression of our values. High ideals are the essence of The Chill Concept experience. We believe that good beginnings lead to great success.

Thank you for being part of our culture!

Biographies of the Authors

Andreina Fuentes (born Venezuela, 1968) is a Social Museologist (José María Vargas University). She has worked as an entrepreneur in art and museums management, social museology, contemporary art fairs and exhibition production. She also develops contemporary art research, social art and community outreach. She is currently the head of The Chill Concept project in the city of Miami (Florida, USA).

Gerardo Zavarce (born Venezuela, 1972) attained his Bachelor of Arts from the Universidad Central de Venezuela (UCV). He has worked as a researcher, developer and advisor in the areas of culture and visual arts. He has taught in the departments of sociology of art, analysis of socio-cultural reality, aesthetic seminar and community service of the arts school of the UCV. He has participated as an organizer and speaker at national and international events and collaborates with various art publications. He currently serves as curator and independent researcher.